

Youngee Son

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Education

Michigan State University, East Lansing, MI
Ph.D. in Economics (M.A. 2024) · Fields: Health, Labor

Expected May 2027

Korea University, Seoul, Korea
B.S. in Economics (2016)

2010 – 2016

Research

Organ Availability and Transplant Candidate Behavior

Job Market Paper

How the 2020 redesign of U.S. liver allocation changed which offers patients accept, and whether it left them better off.

- Built an offer-level panel of 8.6M deceased-donor liver offers (SRTR, 2016–2023) by merging matchrun, donor, candidate, and geocoded facility records
- Simulated counterfactual offer allocation process across 312 urgency-by-market cells to construct a measure of each candidate's change in access under a national reallocation of the prioritization rule
- Estimated the effect of the 2020 allocation redesign using difference-in-differences and event-study designs; a one SD access gain lowered offer acceptance by 4.7 pp and 12-months mortality by 1.2 pp
- Trained discard-risk classifiers (Random Forest, XGBoost, MLP) to construct a continuous liver-quality score
- Estimated a continuous-time dynamic discrete choice model via CCP inversion to quantify the accept-versus-wait tradeoff, then solved steady-state equilibrium under untested allocation rules; the reform raised candidate welfare by the equivalent doubling supply, with only 1.6% of candidates made worse off

Work Experience

Research Assistant | Michigan State University

May 2024 – Present

- Constructed an occupation-level measure of caregiving intensity by applying BERT embeddings to O*NET job descriptions; benchmarked against Random Forest and neural network classifiers
- Clustered occupations over 244 O*NET features using unsupervised ML (K-means, Gaussian mixture, hierarchical) and recovered two interpretable caregiving types
- Analyzed CPS microdata (1983-2025) to trace employment shares and hourly wages across caregiving-intensity quartiles by gender, and decomposed the sources of change

Teaching Assistant | Michigan State University

Aug 2022 – Present

- Supported undergraduate and graduate economics courses. Led review sessions and workshops, including introductory Stata, R and Econometrics.

Junior Economist | Bank of Korea (BOK)

Feb 2016 – May 2022

- Planned and operated Bank Intermediated Lending Facility (equivalent to TLTRO in ECB) to support small and medium-sized enterprises.
- Assessed the default risk of bond issuing firms that BOK purchased bonds from, using the Expected Default Frequency model, and report the results to the Monetary Policy Board.
- Performed empirical analysis on the effectiveness of BOK's emergency lending facility on the corporate bond market and firms' financing conditions.
- Cooperated with Ministry of Economy and Finance, Financial Services Commission and International Monetary Fund to share policy understanding and build a mutual assistance system.

Methods & Tools

Statistical Analysis: Causal inference, Discrete choice models, Counterfactual simulation, A/B testing, Exploratory data analysis, Visualization

ML: Supervised (gradient boosting, random forests, neural networks, NLP, SHAP), Unsupervised (K-means, Gaussian mixture models, hierarchical clustering)

Programming & Tools: Python (*NumPy, Pandas, SciPy, scikit-learn, XGBoost, Matplotlib, SHAP, transformers*), R, Stata, MATLAB